

LESSON 18

What the Bible Actually Does in Your Life

7: The Importance of Scripture

Scripture Focus: Psalm 19:7-11 · Romans 12:1-2 · Matthew 4:4 · Psalm 119:11 · 2 Timothy 3:16-17

The Bible is not just a book — it is the inspired Word of God, essential for spiritual growth. Scripture reveals God's character, transforms and renews the mind, nourishes and strengthens the soul, guards against sin, and equips every believer for every good work. To neglect God's Word is to hinder our growth; to treasure it is to flourish.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to Psalm 19:7-11 and Romans 12:1-2 and Matthew 4:4 and Psalm 119:11 and 2 Timothy 3:16-17.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

VOCABULARY

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Temptation	A test or lure toward sin that must be resisted through Scripture, prayer, watchfulness, and dependence on God.
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.
Repentance	A Spirit-enabled change of mind and direction: turning from sin and toward God with faith-filled obedience.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see What the Bible Actually Does in Your Life from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The Bible is not just a book — it is the inspired Word of God, essential for spiritual growth. Scripture reveals God's character, transforms and renews the mind, nourishes and strengthens the soul, guards against sin, and equips every believer for every good work. To neglect God's Word is to hinder our growth; to treasure it is to flourish.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

Psalm 19:7-11 and Romans 12:1-2 and Matthew 4:4 and Psalm 119:11 and 2 Timothy 3:16-17 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. In verse 16 of second Timothy, it says, All scripture is breathed out by God.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. The scriptures are essential for knowing God, growing in our faith, and living a life that honors him. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

Psalm 19:7-11

Psalm 19:7-11 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Psalm 19:7-11 first, then read Romans 12:1-2 and Matthew 4:4 and Psalm 119:11 and 2 Timothy 3:16-17. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

It is through his word, the Bible, that God has chosen to reveal himself to us.

Study the passage:

1. *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
2. *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
3. *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

FRAMEWORK

Reading vs. Studying Scripture

MATURE STUDY	SHALLOW HABIT
Observes what the text says.	Moves quickly to personal impressions.
Interprets the passage in context.	Pulls a verse away from its meaning.
Applies truth faithfully.	Collects information without obedience.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does What the Bible Actually Does in Your Life most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. For every believer, the Bible is not optional. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. We're going to talk about what scripture does for us, how it should be so precious to you and me, and then we'll actually talk about how to study it, how you in your devotional time can dive into the word and glean what God has for you. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

What the Bible Actually Does in Your Life belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. We start living differently in our daily lives because God's word has taken root in our hearts. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **What the Bible Actually Does in Your Life should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **The scriptures are essential for knowing God, growing in our faith, and living a life that honors him.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about what the bible actually does in your life?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about what the bible actually does in your life. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use Psalm 19:7-11 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
